

ER OON Operating Model 2027

We meet the January 1 Gateway deadline with Model C. Lebanon prepares every dispute in the IDR Prep Studio; a five-person US desk copies it into the Gateway and submits. Every account gets one owner from coding to payment, and people grow by skill.

● Hard deadline: the IDR Gateway becomes US-only on January 1, 2027

5

US desk staff with Model C, about 15 minutes per dispute

10

full-cycle teams replace 12 facility teams

L1–L5

five levels; 9 skill badges drive level, pay and routing

12 → 31

facilities absorbed in two years without new teams

\$328–400K

saved a year by year two with Model C, against Model A

WHY NOW

Three pressures arrive together

Each one alone would justify change. Together they make the current facility-based structure untenable.

Jan 1

The Gateway goes US-only

Our negotiators spend 50–70% of their time in it today. From January 1, only US-based staff may use it.

5×

Workload is uneven

Open claims per person range from 138 to 704 across facility teams. Effort, not geography, should set the load.

+19

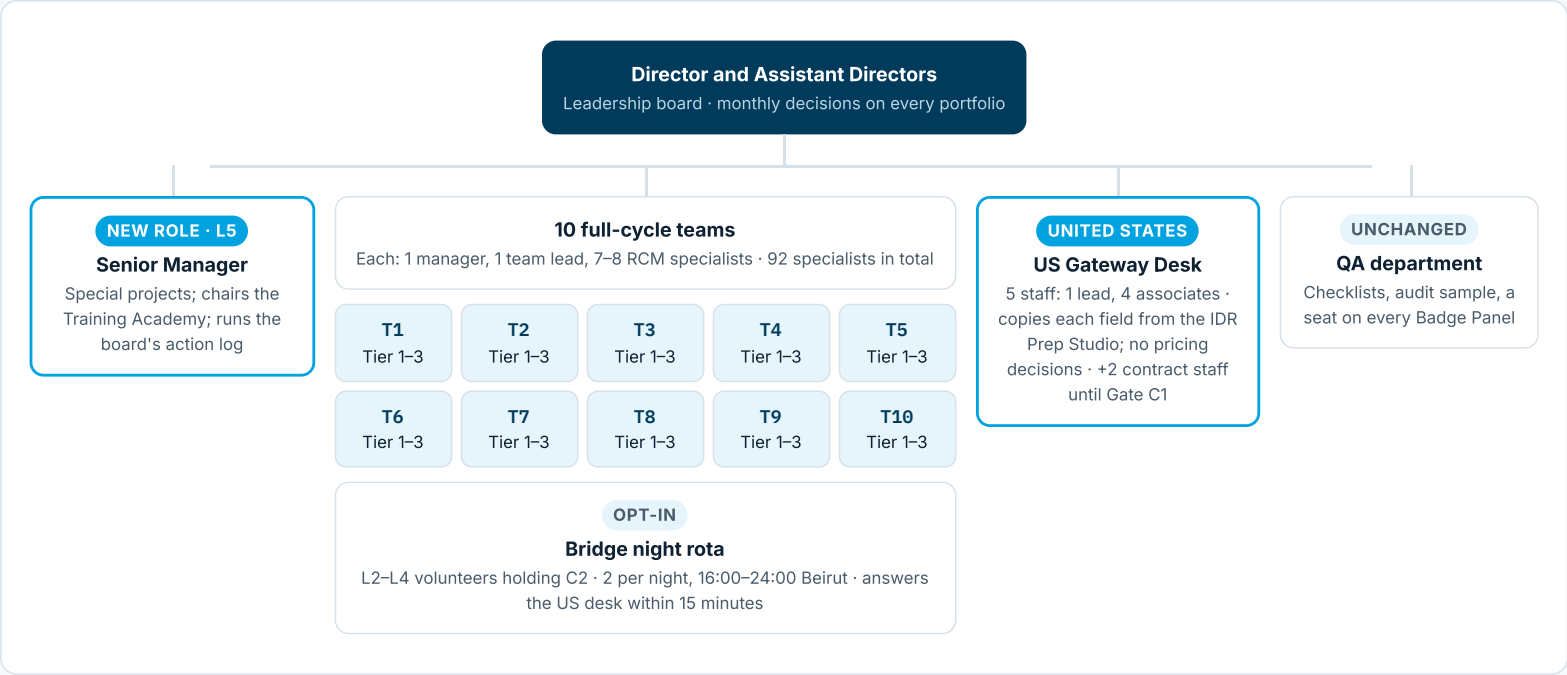
We are growing fast

We go from 12 to 31 facilities in two years. The model must absorb them without adding a team for each one.

THE STRUCTURE

One owner per account, ten balanced teams, a US desk for the Gateway

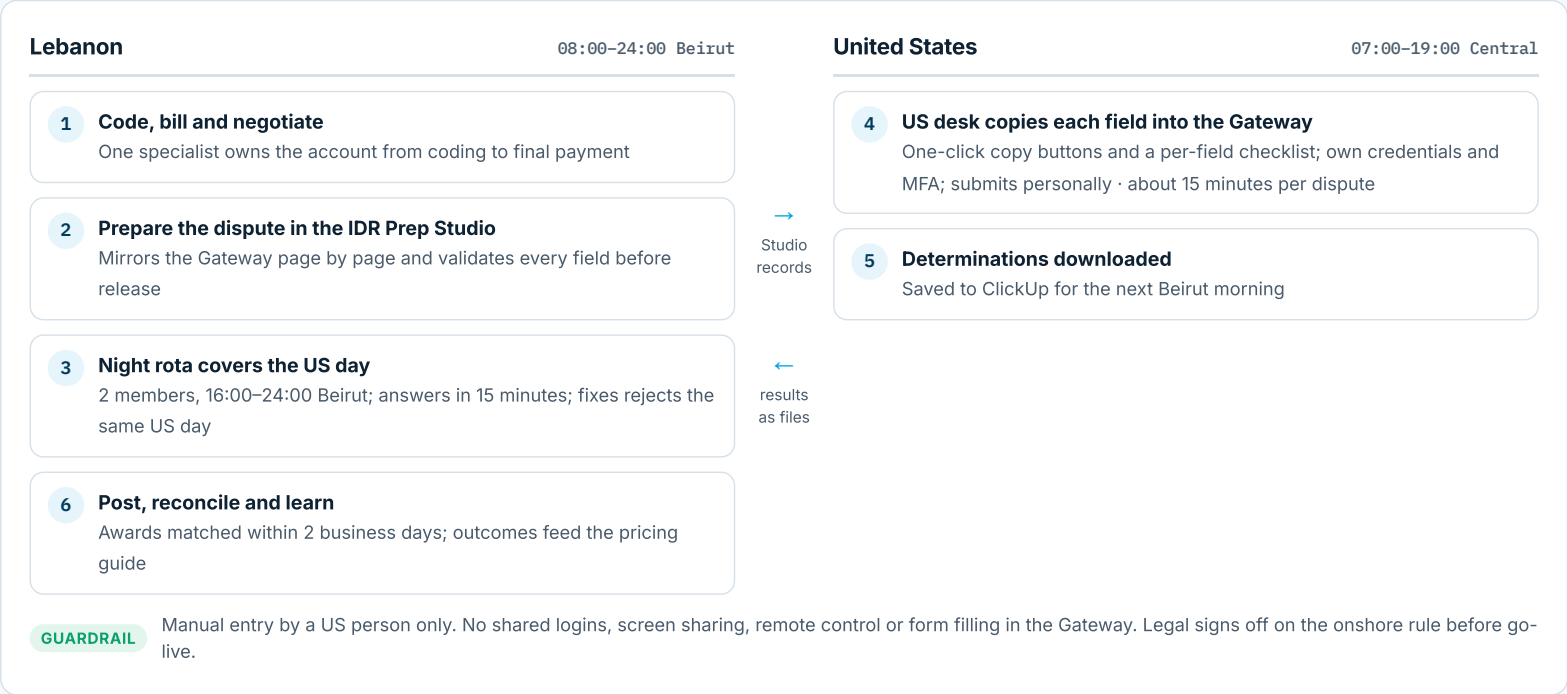
Teams own payer portfolios, not facilities. Lebanon prepares every dispute and keeps every pricing decision; the US desk only copies the prepared work into the Gateway.



HOW WORK MOVES

Lebanon prepares in the Studio, the US copies and files, results return overnight

Only prepared work crosses the boundary. No one outside the US ever sees or operates a Gateway session, and no tool touches the Gateway.



Volunteers cover the US day, paid from a fixed quarterly pool

The night rota replaces the two team leads on the old bridge shift. Any L2, L3 or L4 holding C2 can opt in. It reports to the Onshore–Offshore Liaison portfolio owner.

16:00–24:00

Beirut, Monday to Friday
(08:00–16:00 Central)

2

members a night, at least
one A2 holder as night lead

130

member-nights a quarter

Duties

Check tickets due that day, answer the US desk within 15 minutes, fix rejected tickets the same US day, post the nightly handover log.

Full share when

98% first-pass tickets, US desk answered within 15 minutes, no deadline missed because of a ticket, and all assigned nights worked. Swaps allowed; missed nights reduce the share pro rata.

Rota set each quarter from the opt-ins: 10 members at 1 night a week, up to 20 at 1 night every other week, or any size in between. Transport home after the shift as before.

\$30,000 a quarter, shared equally

ROTA MEMBERS	BONUS PER MEMBER, PER QUARTER	
10	\$3,000	
15	\$2,000	
20	\$1,500	
30	\$1,000	
50	\$600	
100	\$300	

About \$230 per night worked at any rota size. The \$300 floor caps the rota at 100. Up to \$120,000 a year, replacing the old \$6,000 for two team leads.

Model C is ready for January 1 and keeps most of the saving

All three share the ten full-cycle teams, levels, badges and pay bands. They differ only in how Gateway filing is done. Recruiting is in-house, so no recruiting fees are included.

Model A · People-first

SAFEST, COSTLIEST

7	~47 min	\$346–421K
US desk staff	per dispute	US desk a year today

- US desk types from ClickUp tickets
- Ready on January 1 · legal sign-off on the onshore rule only
- Absorbs absences well · 1 of 7 people
- Cost grows with volume · \$861K–1.05M by year two

Model B · Automation-first

BIGGEST SAVING, MOST RISK

3	~10 min	\$206–261K
US desk staff	target per dispute	US desk and AI a year today

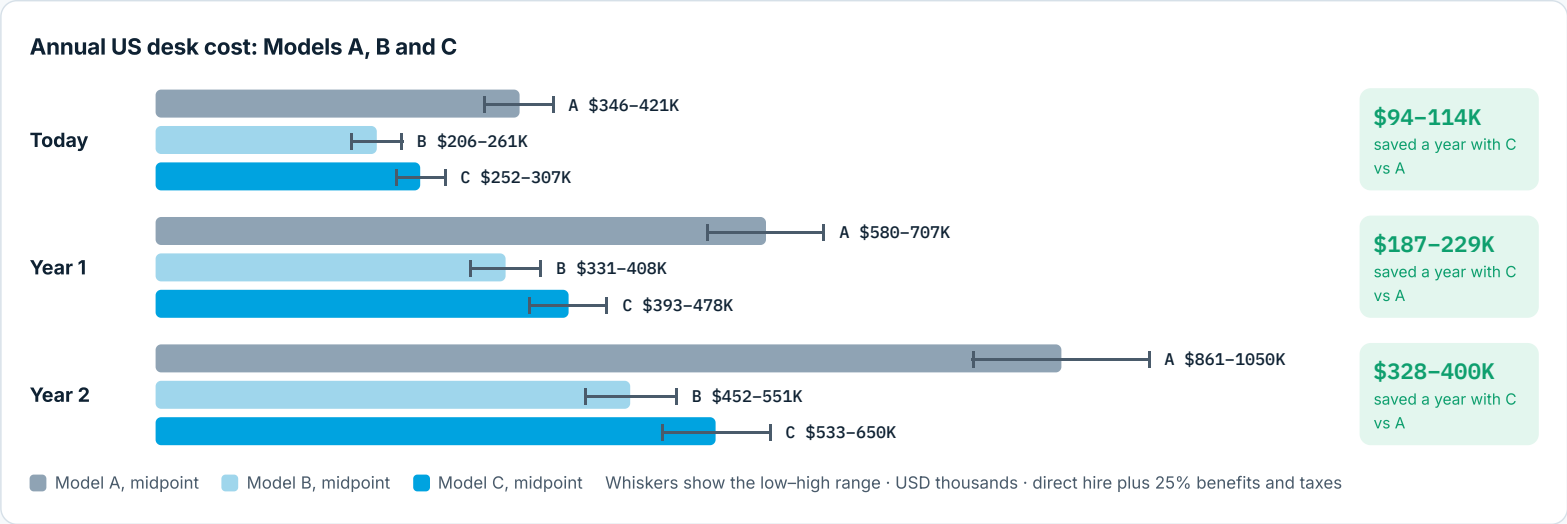
- A Submission Cockpit fills the Gateway · operator checks and submits
- Needs written Gateway confirmation that assisted filling is allowed
- Not ready on January 1 · runs on A's desk until Gate 2, April 30
- Fragile to absence · 1 of 3 people

Model C · Guided copy desk

PROPOSED · MIDDLE GROUND

5	~15 min	\$252–307K
US desk staff	target per dispute	US desk a year today

- Lebanon prepares in the IDR Prep Studio · validates every field
- US desk copies each field and submits personally · no tool touches the Gateway
- Ready on January 1 · Studio built, tested, used in the December parallel run
- Absorbs absences · 1 of 5 people; two shifts, 07:00–19:00 Central



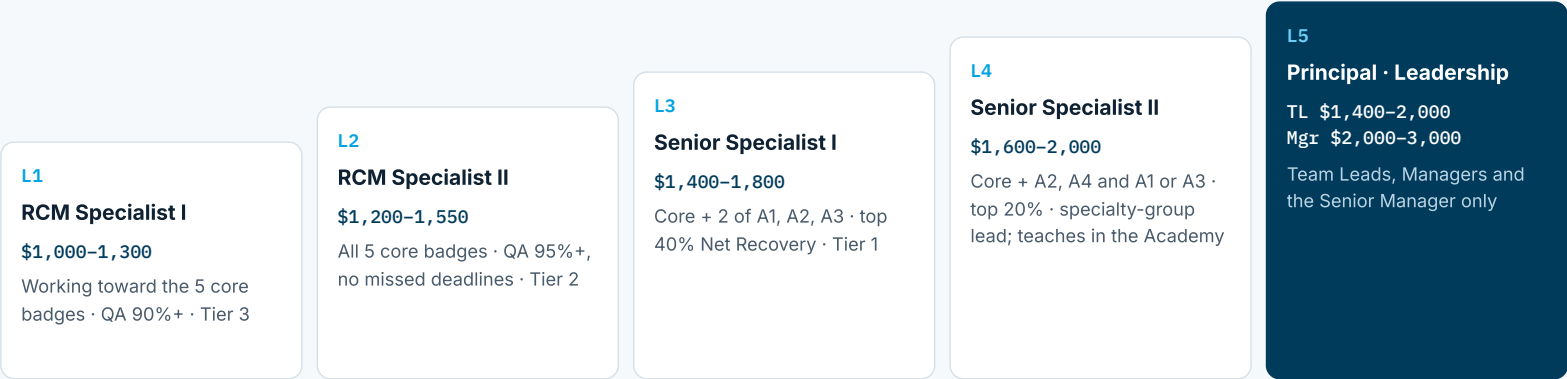
QUESTION	MODEL A	MODEL B	MODEL C	EDGE
Ready for January 1?	Yes	No; runs on A's desk until Gate 2, April 30	Yes; Studio built and tested	A, C
Outside approvals needed	Legal sign-off on the onshore rule	Also written Gateway confirmation of assisted filling	Onshore rule only (manual entry by a US person)	A, C
Time per dispute	About 47 minutes	Target 10 minutes	Target 15 minutes	B
Resilience to absence	1 of 7 people	1 of 3 people	1 of 5 people	A
Lebanon specialists by year two	About 125	About 102, with AI drafting	About 125; can add AI drafting later	B
Cost by year two	\$861K–1.05M	\$452–551K	\$533–650K	B
Main risk	Cost grows with volume	Gateway terms; a 3-person desk	Copy errors, checked by Studio validation, a per-field checklist and bridge review	C

Recommendation: propose Model C. It is ready for January 1 with tools we already have, needs no Gateway approval beyond the onshore rule, keeps a 5-person desk that absorbs absences, and saves \$94–114K a year today and \$328–400K by year two against Model A. That is about 70–80% of Model B's saving with far less risk.

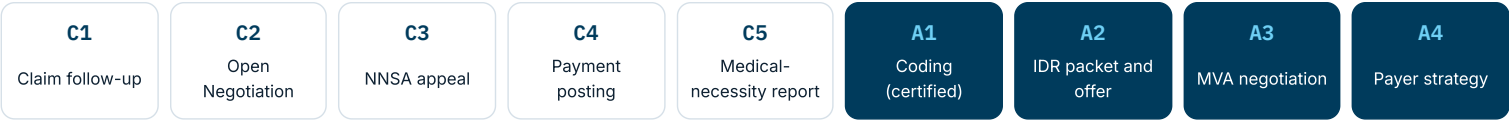
PEOPLE AND CAREERS

One role, five levels, earned by skill

Former titles no longer set pay or work. Nine badges certify what each specialist can do alone, control what ClickUp routes to them, and open the next level. L1–L4 are specialist levels; L5 is leadership. Pay bands are USD per month.



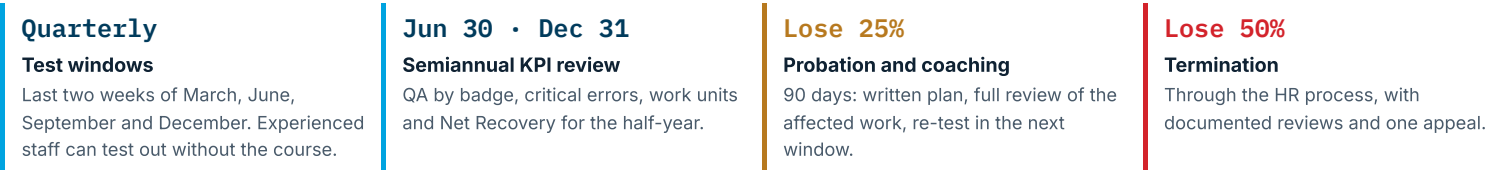
The nine badges



Leadership (L5): L3 or L4 + coaching assessment → **Team Lead** \$1,400–2,000 12 months as TL, or L4 + leadership training → **Manager** \$2,000–3,000

Senior Manager band to be set.

Keep your badges



Counted against badges held at the start of the half-year. The June 2027 review is coaching only; consequences start with the December 2027 review. Subject to HR and legal review under Lebanese labor law before publication.

Everyone starts at a default level and confirms it with tests

In December 2026 every member is ranked within their current role on 2026 KPIs. The ranking decides who is confirmed automatically, who tests, and who starts in the Academy. Levels take effect on April 1, 2027.

Top 10%

Badges earned automatically

No tests. Confirmed at their default level with the badges of their current role.

- Negotiator: C2, A2, C5
- Coder: A1 (if certified), C5
- Biller: C1, C3, C4, C5; A3 for MVA settlements

Middle 80%

Three months to pass the role's badge tests

Optional full skill assessment in January shows needs and current level. Tests in the February or March windows, January 4 to March 31.

PASS

Confirmed at the default level

PASS NEXT LEVEL

Move up one level, for example a Biller to L3

FAIL

Move down one level (L3 → L2, L2 → L1)

Bottom 10%

L1 and the Academy

Enrolled in the Academy and placed at L1. Can sit the skill assessment in any test window to return to L2.

Default level by current role	
Seniors	L3 Senior Specialist I
Negotiators, Coders, Billers	L2 RCM Specialist II
Team Leads	L5 Team Lead
Managers	L5 Manager

Pay during the transition

No pay cuts

Including anyone moved down a level. Above-band pay is frozen; merit is paid as a lump sum.

Raise on upgrade

Guaranteed from April 1, 2027: +10–12% or the new band minimum, whichever is higher.

Dec 2026	Jan 2027	Feb–Mar 2027	Apr 1, 2027	Jun 30, 2027
Rank	Skill assessment	Test windows	Levels take effect	Core badges
Top and bottom 10% published	Optional; shows needs and level	Role badges, core and advanced	Raises paid on upgrades	Missing ones earned by cross-training

OUR COMMITMENT

No one loses their job or pay because of the restructure. From December 2027 everyone is held to the same badge and performance standards.

TRAINING ACADEMY

A new hire becomes a full account owner in six months

Training happens on live work: about 20% classroom, 80% supervised production checked by a badge-holder. A committee awards badges and recommends promotions; no one decides alone on their own team. Each Badge Panel is a QA reviewer plus 2 assessors (L4s or Team Leads) from other teams.

The Academy Committee			From day one to L2		
1	Chair and owner	A manager, preferably the Senior Manager	Weeks 1–2	Months 1–2	Month 3
			Onboarding	C1 + C4	C5
			HIPAA, systems, NSA	Follow-up, posting	Medical necessity
2–3	Managers	From different teams; 12-month staggered terms			
2+2	L4 Senior Specialists II and L3 Senior Specialists I	Lead trainers and assessors; teaching counts toward L4	Months 4–5	Month 6	Next window
			C2	C3	L2
			Open Negotiation	NNSA appeal	Account owner
2	Team leads, rotating	New pair each quarter; 8 serve every year			
1	QA reviewer	Scores quality; sits on every Badge Panel	100%	2+	4×
			core badges held by June 30, 2027	holders of every badge in every team	test windows a year, every badge offered

LEADERSHIP PORTFOLIOS

Every manager owns one area the model depends on

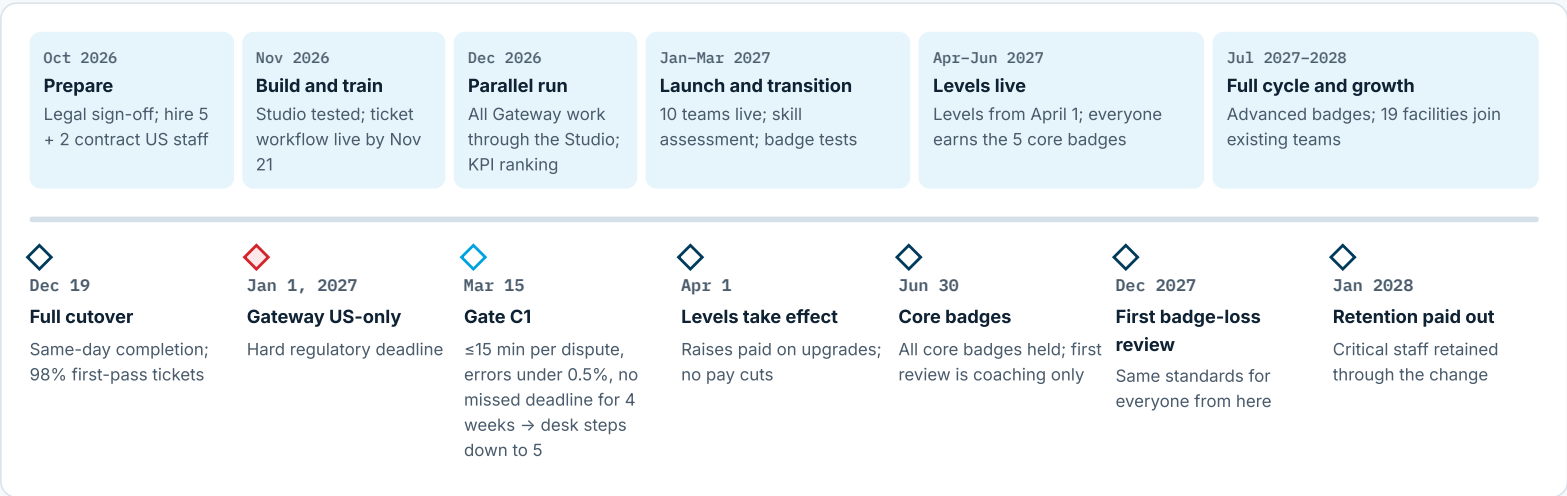
Eleven portfolios, one per manager and the Senior Manager. Owners are assigned by the leadership board. Dashed tiles are additions the model needs to succeed.

Training Academy	Payments and Reconciliation	Onshore–Offshore Liaison	External Relations
Onboard, train, test, award, promote	Every dollar posted and reconciled	Lebanon, US desk, night rota, accounting	IDR entities and payers
Core badges for all by June 30, 2027	IDR awards matched in 2 business days	98% same-day completion	80% of escalations resolved in 30 days
Automation, ClickUp, AI and Data	Coding Quality	Denials and NNSA Strategy	IDR Performance
Tools, the Studio, one source of numbers	Guidelines and E/M level ratios	Patterns, appeals, letter library	Results by location, payer, entity
Dashboards ready by the 3rd business day	95% coding audit accuracy	Denial rate down every quarter	Win rate and recovery after fees
Compliance and Deadlines	Pricing Guide	Capacity and Growth	How they report
Deadlines, HIPAA, Gateway access	Offers, settlements, decision rights	Workload balance, 19 new facilities	Findings and recommendations, every month
Zero missed regulatory deadlines	100% inside the guide or approved	Teams within 90–110% of target	One template, one set of numbers

Monthly report	Monthly leadership board	Quarterly deep-dive	Yearly review
To the director and assistant directors by the 5th business day	Each owner presents findings; the board decides	Every portfolio reviewed in depth once a quarter	Targets reset; owners confirmed or rotated

The Gateway first, then the teams, then the levels

The cutover happens on December 19, two weeks before the deadline. Team structure changes only after the Gateway is stable, and levels take effect after the transition tests.



If Gate C1 is missed, or the backlog stays above one business day for 5 days, or the desk causes a missed deadline, we extend the contracts or add staff, back toward Model A. Model B's Cockpit stays a later option once the Gateway confirms assisted filling is allowed.

RISKS WE ARE MANAGING

Every major risk has an owner and a fallback

We misread the Gateway's onshore rule

HIGH IMPACT

Legal sign-off before the build; offshore access stays as a fallback until December 19.

Patient data in Google Workspace without a HIPAA BAA

HIGH IMPACT

The Studio runs on Google Workspace. A signed BAA must cover it before any real PHI enters the Studio.

Copy errors at the US desk

MODEL C

Studio validates every field; per-field checklist; night rota review. Gate C1 requires errors under 0.5%.

The US desk falls behind as volume grows

MEDIUM

Contract staff stay until Gate C1; a backlog trigger extends them or adds staff.

People read new levels as a demotion

MEDIUM

Default levels, no pay cuts, a guaranteed raise on upgrade, published criteria and one appeal.

We lose IDR experts during the change

HIGH IMPACT

Retention bonus through January 2028 and an L4 path that does not require managing.

DECISIONS REQUESTED TODAY

Seven approvals to start in October

1

Approve Model C for the US Gateway Desk

5 permanent staff (1 lead, 4 associates) plus 2 contract staff until Gate C1, hired in-house from October

2

Approve the 10 full-cycle teams

Launch in January–February 2027, after the Gateway cutover

3

Approve levels L1–L5, badges and pay bands

Including L4 Senior Specialist II and L5 Principal as the leadership level

4

Approve the testing and badge-loss policy

Quarterly tests, semiannual review; subject to HR and legal review

5

Approve the transition plan

Ranking in December, tests January–March, levels effective April 1, 2027

6

Approve the bridge night rota

Opt-in L2–L4; a \$30,000 bonus pool each quarter

7

Create the Senior Manager role and the portfolios

Senior Manager (L5) in place before the Academy set-up

Sources: ER OON Operating Model 2027 executive summary; Models A, B and C comparison; RCM Specialist Badge Competency Matrix; Training Academy curriculum; Manager portfolios appendix. US cost figures are approximate Texas market rates for direct hires plus 25% benefits and payroll taxes, not quotes. Recruiting is in-house and infrastructure is already in place, so neither is included.